

ALT Lesson Plan

School Name: University of Chicago	ALT:	Date(s): 03/06/2025
Year(s) / Class(es): Undergraduate and Graduate University Students	Period(s): 6:30pm-7:20pm CST	Lesson Objectives: Opinionated speaking: - Students will practice expressing opinions and giving advice using auxiliary verbs (should, would, could). Creative generation in L2: - Students will creatively respond to hypothetical scenarios and life advice columns. Practicing more casual English: - Students will engage in pair and group discussions to simulate casual, conversational English.
Vocabulary: Auxiliary verbs (should, would, could) and phrases for giving advice.	Other:	Materials: PowerPoint presentation on auxiliary verbs (should, would, could). “Dear Abby” life advice columns: https://www.uexpress.com/life/dearabby . Board and Chalk for discussion/real time correction

Time:		Materials:
6:30-6:40 (10 minutes)	Warmup: Students introduce themselves using the icebreaker prompt: “If I were X, I would Y.” This activity indirectly scaffolds the topic of auxiliary verbs and encourages creative thinking in L2.	
6:40 - 6:50 (10 minutes)	Introduction: Instructor presents a powerpoint on auxiliary verbs like should, would, and could. This presentation explains their uses and provides examples.	
6:50 - 6:55 (5 minutes)	Instruction: Instructors explain the activity: Students will read a “Dear Abby” column, summarize the scenario, and give advice using auxiliary verbs. Ask if there are any clarifying questions	https://englishlive.ef.com/en/blog/language-lab/use-should-would-could/ .
6:55 - 7:05 (10 minutes)	Production: Students read the “Dear Abby” Column aloud, summarize, and practice giving advice in pairs as “Abby” using auxiliary verbs. Instructors will walk around the classroom and provide support or answer questions.	
7:05 - 7:20 (15 minutes)	Reflection (7 min): Students will share the advice they received/ shared with the whole class or give commentary on the advice given by “Abby” in the actual column piece. (8 minutes): Instructors discuss common mistakes made and reinforce auxiliary verb usage. Pause for questions and general discussion about the activity	https://www.uexpress.com/life/dearabby/2025/02/25

This lesson integrates all four skills (speaking, listening, reading, and writing) and focuses on opinionated speaking and creative generation in L2. We set up the student for success by giving a refresher about auxiliary verbs. The “Dear Abby” activity provides authentic material for students to practice giving advice, a practical and culturally relevant skill. The reflection phase ensures students receive immediate feedback on their language use, reinforcing accuracy and confidence. This structure aligns with communicative language teaching principles, emphasizing real-world application and student interaction.

ALTERNATIVELY: Another lesson plan that we could pivot to is a game called “Objection”. We were introduced to it as an improvisational comedy game but I believe it could work well in this context and non comedically.

- Instructors choose a topic for the town to debate. Someone starts off by stating their opinion on the topic. Students “object” by picking a word that the currently speaking student has said and saying, “Objection”. The instructor then calls on the student that objected and asks what their objection is. The objecting student then uses the word they chose from the previous speaker to create a new argument.

Example:

Topic: We should get rid of all trees in the neighborhood.

Speaker 1: These trees shed easily and I hate raking up leaves.

Speaker 2: Objection

Instructor: Yes?

Speaker 2: I’m actually the leaves that Speaker 1 mentioned, and I love being raked up.

Instructor (has the option to let Speaker 1 continue or accept the objection). Accepted! Please tell us about how much you like being raked up!

Speaker 2: Do you like back scratches? So do we. If you stopped raking the leaves, those leaves would never get to experience a backscratch again.

Speaker 3: Objection, I’m a human back.

Instructor: Okay, let us hear your objection.

Speaker 3: I’m a human back and I hate getting scratched. It makes me really red and sometimes I get a rash.